siderable technical progress in the arts and amenities of life, creating not only things of beauty, but also the utilitarian and more typical emblems of modern civilization—good baths and drainage systems.

The C o m i n g o f the A r y a n s

Who were these people of the Indus Valley civilization and whence had they come? We do not know yet. It is quite possible, and even probable, that their culture was an indigenous culture and its roots and offshoots may be found even in southern India. Some scholars find an essential similarity between these people and the Dravidian races and culture of south India. Even if there was some ancient migration to India, this could only have taken place some thousands of years before the date assigned to Mohenjo-daro. For all practical purposes we can treat them as the indigenous inhabitants of India.

W h a t happened to the Indus Valley civilization and how did it e n d ? Some people (among them, Gordon Childe) say that there was a sudden end to it due to an unexplained catastrophe.

T h e river Indus is well-known for its mighty floods which overwhelm and wash away cities and villages. Or a changing climate